

Rubric for Presentations

Adapted from the 8 competencies of public speaking (Morreale, 1990).

Name: _____ Topic: _____

Presentation:	Week 1	Midterm	Final
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Competency	Below Average (1-2)	Satisfactory (3-4)	Excellent (5)	Score (1-5)
Thesis/Focus	The speaker does not communicate a thesis or specific purpose that is adequately clear and identifiable.	The speaker communicates a thesis/specific purposes that is adequately clear and identifiable That is, at least a majority of the audience should understand clearly, within the opening few sentences of the presentation, precisely what the specific purpose/thesis of the presentation is.	The speaker communicates a thesis/specific purposes that is exceptionally clear and identifiable. That is, there is no question that all of the audience members should understand clearly, within the opening few sentences of the presentation, precisely what the specific purpose/thesis of the presentation is.	
Supporting Materials	The speaker uses supporting material that is inappropriate in quality and variety. That is, supporting material is only vaguely related to the thesis of the presentation, and is either too great or too little to do anything but detract from the effectiveness of the presentation.	The speaker uses supporting material that appropriate in quality and variety. That is, supporting material is logically linked to the thesis of the presentation, and is of such quality that it adds a measurable level of interest to the presentation.	The speaker used supporting material that is exceptional in quality and variety. That is, supporting material is unarguably linked to the thesis of the presentation, and further is of such quality that it decidedly enhances the credibility of the speaker and the clarity of the topic.	
Logical flow of materials (intro,	The speaker fails to use an appropriate introduction and conclusion and fails to provide a	The speaker uses an introduction and conclusion and provides a reasonably clear and logical	The speaker uses an exceptional introduction and conclusion and provides an exceptionally clear and logical	

ideas, and conclusion)	reasonably clear and logical progression within and between ideas That is, the introduction fails to engage even a majority of the audience in an appropriate and creative manner, the body of the presentation reflects lack of clarity in organization, and the conclusion fails to leave even a majority of the audience with a clear message or call to action.	progression within and between ideas. That is, the introduction clearly engages a majority of the audience in an appropriate and creative manner, the body of the presentation reflects adequate clarity in organization, and the conclusion adequately reflects the content of the presentation and leaves a majority of the audience with a clear message or call to action.	progression within and between ideas. That is, the introduction clearly engages a majority of the audience in an appropriate and creative manner, the body of the presentation reflects adequate clarity in organization, and the conclusion adequately reflects the content of the presentation and leaves a majority of the audience with a clear message or call to action.	
Appropriate Language	The speaker uses unclear or inappropriate language with no spontaneous additions to the presentation. That is, the speaker used inappropriate jargon, or language which is sexist, racist, etc. and exhibits discomfort with anything but delivery of the prepared text.	The speaker uses language that is reasonably clear, vivid, and appropriate and occasionally inserts spontaneous comments. That is, the speaker chooses language that is free of inappropriate jargon, is nonsexist, is nonracist, etc. and exhibits a limited degree of comfort with impromptu additions to his/her text.	The speaker uses language that is exceptionally clear, vivid, and appropriate and inserts spontaneous comments with ease and confidence. That is, the speaker chooses language that enhances audience comprehension and enthusiasm for the presentation, while adding a measure of creativity in adapting ideas to the audience and that displays exceptional sensitivity by the speaker for denotation and connotation of meaning	
Uses vocal variety in rate, pitch and intensity. Proper grammar and articulation	The speaker fails to use acceptable vocal variety, articulation, pronunciation, and grammar and fails to speak in a conversational mode. That is, non-fluencies and disfluencies interfere with the message and frequent errors in pronunciation and grammar make it difficult for the audience to understand the message. In addition, the speaker shows frequent weaknesses in controlling and adapting pace,	The speaker has acceptable articulation with a few pronunciation and grammar errors, and makes acceptable use of vocal variety in a conversation with forethought mode of delivery That is, most sounds are properly formed, there are only minor vocalized disfluencies, and a few (1-2) minor errors in pronunciation and grammar. In addition, the speaker shows only occasional weakness in pace, volume, pitch, etc. thereby not	The speaker has exceptional pronunciation, grammar, and articulation, and makes exceptional use of vocal variety in a conversation with forethought mode of delivery. That is, the speaker exhibits properly formed sounds which enhance the message, and no pronunciation or grammatical errors. In addition, the speaker's vocal delivery is exceptionally and appropriate well-paced, easily heard by all audience members, and variety in pitch to enhance the message.	

	volume, pitch, etc. resulting in an overall detracting from the quality or impact of the presentation.	detracting significantly from the overall quality or impact of the presentation.		
Uses physical behaviors that support the verbal message & communicates engagement with audience through confidence, sincerity & enthusiasm for the topic.	The speaker fails to use acceptable posture, gestures, bodily movement, facial expressions, eye contact, and use of dress, fails to engage the audience and shows little to no confidence, sincerity, and enthusiasm for the topic. That is, kinesics (posture, gesture, facial expressions, eye contact) and proxemic (interpersonal distance and spatial arrangement) behaviors and dress are incongruent with the verbal intent and detract from the speaker's credibility with the audience as well as distracting the audience from the speaker's message. 3	The speaker demonstrates acceptable posture, gestures, bodily movement, facial expressions, eye contact, and use of dress that to a limited degree engages the audience and shows some confidence, sincerity, and enthusiasm for the topic. Behaviors and dress generally support the verbal message with minor inconsistencies that neither significantly distract from the speaker's credibility with the audience nor interfere with the message.	The speaker demonstrates exceptional posture, gestures, bodily movement, facial expressions, eye contact, and use of dress that engage the audience and show demonstrate confidence, sincerity, and enthusiasm for the topic. Behaviors and dress consistently support the verbal message and thereby enhance the speaker's commitment to the presentation topic and active relationship with the audience.	
Total Score (out of 30)				

Other comments: